

ETHERIA

Style Beyond Reality

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

People & Wellbeing Strategy 2026

Prepared by: Business Analyst | May 2026 | Version 1.0

Document Title	Gap Analysis Report — People & Wellbeing Strategy 2025
Client	Etheria — Phygital Fashion-Tech Brand
Reference	Client Brief v1.0 BRD v1.0 SQL Analysis Findings
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1. Purpose of the Document

This Gap Analysis Report compares Etheria's current state of workforce wellbeing management (As-Is) with the desired future state (To-Be) as identified through SQL data analysis of the 100-employee dataset. Each section presents findings from the analysis, the gap between current and desired state, and specific data-backed recommendations for the HR team to act on.

2. As-Is VS To-Be Summary

Dimension	As-Is (Current State)	To-Be (Desired State)
Burnout Monitoring	No structured tracking, burnout identified only when employees escalate or leave	Monthly monitoring dashboard in place tracking burnout by work mode, role, and region
Sleep & Lifestyle	No visibility into employee lifestyle factors affecting burnout	Regular pulse surveys tracking sleep quality and lifestyle habits with HR follow-up
Work Mode Policy	Work mode decided informally by individual managers with no data-driven policy	Hybrid-first policy implemented based on data showing hybrid as most productive and lowest burnout
Mental Health Support	Therapist access provided reactively — only when burnout is already high	Proactive mental health programs addressing root causes — sleep, workload distribution, routine
Job Role Workload	Workload distribution monitored only at project level, not team health level	Regular workload audits per team with daily standups ensuring even distribution
Country Wellbeing	No country-level wellbeing visibility — global HR policy applied uniformly	Region-specific interventions based on burnout data — especially for high-burnout regions

3. Burnout Root Cause Analysis (FR-01)

3.1 Key Findings

What the data shows:

- Sleep quality is the strongest burnout driver and employees with poor sleep average 53.89 burnout vs 47.33 for good sleepers reporting a gap of 6.56 points
- Working hours showed an unexpected result. Overworked employees (45.00) had lower burnouts than normal-hours employees (51.07), which is likely due to the small sample size and warrants further investigation.
- Exercise frequency showed a contradictory result. Employees who never exercise had the lowest burnout (46.12) while those exercising 2-3 times per week had the highest (51.86), making it statistically inconclusive.

3.2 Gap

Dimension	As-Is (Current State)	To-Be (Desired State)
Sleep Tracking	Etheria has no visibility into employee sleep patterns or rest quality	Monthly pulse surveys and sleep quality monitoring introduced for all remote and hybrid employees
Working Hours	Hours worked per week are tracked at project level only, not correlated with wellbeing	Hours worked monitored and flagged if any employee crosses 45 hours per week consistently
Lifestyle Support	No lifestyle or wellness programs in place to support employee habits	Structured wellness programs introduced addressing sleep hygiene, routine building, and rest

3.3 Recommendations

1. Introduce structured rest and sleep hygiene awareness, including recommended hour cutoffs, no-meeting blocks, and awareness sessions on the link between rest and performance.
2. Investigate further with the full 600+ employee dataset before drawing any policy conclusions about working hours.

4. Work Mode VS Mental Health (FR-02)

4.1 Key Findings

What the data shows:

- Remote employees report the highest average burnout (51), followed by Onsite (49) and Hybrid (47)
- Remote employees with Good mental health report the highest burnout of 62.73, even mentally healthy remote workers are burning out, suggesting structural issues with remote work at Etheria beyond individual mental health
- Hybrid employees with Poor mental health have the lowest burnout (42.00), likely because disengaged employees work less intensely, not because hybrid work is solving their mental health issues
- Onsite employees show the most consistent burnout range (45.22 to 54.00) suggesting a structured physical environment produces more predictable and manageable stress levels

4.2 Gap

Dimension	As-Is (Current State)	To-Be (Desired State)
Remote Work Structure	Remote employees have no structured check-ins or boundaries separating work from personal time	Structured remote work protocols to be introduced, defined working hours, mandatory log-off times, and weekly check-ins

Hybrid Policy	Hybrid arrangements decided informally with no data-backed rationale	Hybrid model formally adopted as the preferred work mode given its lowest burnout and highest productivity profile
Mental Health Tracking	Mental health status is not monitored by work mode, no differentiated support	Work-mode-specific mental health interventions introduced, with particular focus on remote employee burnout

4.3 Recommendations

1. Move toward a structured hybrid policy as the default, with remote and onsite options available but actively managed to prevent burnout escalation.
2. Implement defined working hours, mandatory log-off notifications, no-meeting Fridays, and regular manager check-ins specifically for remote employees.

5. Productivity & Work Life Balance Analysis (FR-03)

5.1 Key Findings

What the data shows:

- Hybrid employees report the highest productivity (6.27) and Remote employees report the highest work-life balance rating (6.45)
- Onsite employees scored lowest on both productivity (5.70) and work-life balance (5.80) despite the structured environment
- The overall difference across work modes is less than 0.6 points on a 10-point scale, indicating work mode alone is not the primary productivity driver.

5.2 Gap

Dimension	As-Is (Current State)	To-Be (Desired State)
Productivity Monitoring	Productivity tracked through project delivery only, not correlated with wellbeing factors	Productivity monitored alongside burnout and sleep data to identify root causes of underperformance
Onsite Support	Onsite employees receive no additional support despite lowest productivity and work-life balance scores	Onsite employee experience commute support, flexible hours, and wellbeing initiatives
Reward Systems	No performance-linked wellness or reward system in place	Balanced reward system introduced and targets tied to sustainable performance not just output volume

5.3 Recommendations

1. Introduce a rewards system where teams achieving productivity targets receive recognition or bonuses but also ensure no individual works excessive hours to achieve targets. Weekly fun activities and quarterly team events should also be introduced to maintain morale

6. Job Role Wellbeing Analysis

6.1 Key Findings

What the data shows:

- Product Managers have the highest average burnout (57.78) with the smallest team of 9 employees but only 2 report Poor mental health, suggesting disproportionate workload concentrated among a few high-performing individuals
- QA Engineers have the highest proportion of Poor mental health at 45% (9 out of 20 employees) despite the lowest overall burnout

- Data Scientists and UI/UX Designers have the lowest Poor mental health proportion at 20% and 16.7% respectively, but their small team sizes make these figures less reliable statistically

6.2 Gap

Dimension	As-Is (Current State)	To-Be (Desired State)
Workload Distribution	Workload monitored at project level only, no visibility into individual stress or team-level distribution	Per-team workload audits conducted monthly with managers ensuring even distribution across all members
High Burnout Roles	Product Managers have highest burnout with no dedicated support or workload review mechanism	Product Manager team size reviewed, and additional resources or workload redistribution explored
Team Communication	No structured daily communication mechanism to ensure everyone is on track	Daily standups introduced across all teams (15 minutes) to surface blockers and redistribute work proactively

6.3 Recommendations

1. Managers should conduct monthly workload reviews ensuring no team member is idle while others are overloaded. Daily standups of 15 minutes should be introduced to surface blockers early.
2. Investigate whether the team is understaffed relative to the product scope and consider expanding the team or redistributing responsibilities to reduce individual burnout risk.

7. Country Wise Burnout Trends

7.1 Key Findings

What the data shows:

- India records the highest average burnout at 63.91, followed by Germany at 55.07 and Brazil at 53.88
- Australia reports the lowest burnout at 35.73, followed by UK at 40.22 and Canada at 46.56
- India and Australia share the same sample size of 11 employees yet show a burnout gap of 28.18 points, the largest regional disparity among countries

7.2 Gap

Dimension	As-Is (Current State)	To-Be (Desired State)
India-Australia Gap	28-point burnout gap between India and Australia with no investigation or understanding of contributing factors	Deep-dive investigation commissioned comparing work modes, sleep quality, therapist access, and workload between India and Australia
Regional Interventions	No region-specific support or wellbeing programs exist and one-size-fits-all approach	Country-specific initiatives introduced for high-burnout regions- flexible hours, local wellness programs, and regional HR support

7.3 Recommendations

1. Conduct a detailed comparison of work mode distribution, sleep quality, therapist access, and working hours between these two regions to identify and address the root causes of this disparity.

8. Therapist Access Impact (FR-06)

8.1 Key Findings

What the data shows:

- Employees with therapist access report a slightly higher average burnout of 51.44 compared to 47.50 for those without access.
- This reflects reverse causality. Employees with higher burnout are more likely to seek or be referred to therapy, not that therapy is causing burnout
- Therapist access alone is therefore insufficient as a burnout solution. It is a reactive intervention, not a preventive one.

8.2 Gap

Dimension	As-Is (Current State)	To-Be (Desired State)
Therapy Model	Therapist access provided reactively — employees seek support only after burnout has already escalated	Proactive Mental Health Model introduced with regular check-ins, early warning triggers, and preventive support programs
Root Cause Focus	Wellbeing strategy focused on therapy as the primary intervention with no upstream prevention	Strategy refocused on root causes i.e., sleep quality, work mode structure, and workload distribution, with therapy as a supplementary support

8.3 Recommendations

1. Shift its mental health strategy from reactive (therapy after burnout) to proactive (preventing burnout through sleep programs, structured work modes, and workload management). Therapy should remain available but as a supplementary tool, not the primary intervention.
2. Therapy access to be standardized across all 7 countries as its access is inconsistent globally.

9. Summarized Recommendations

The following 10 recommendations are prioritized based on data evidence and potential impact:

#	Recommendation	Based On	Priority
R1	Introducing rest awareness program	FR-01: Sleep quality is strongest burnout driver (6.56-point gap)	High
R2	Investigate working hours with larger dataset	FR-01: Overwork finding is inconclusive with 100 employees	Medium
R3	Adopt hybrid as default work model	FR-02/03: Hybrid has lowest burnout (47) and highest productivity (6.27)	High
R4	Introducing structured remote work protocols	FR-02: Remote + Good mental health employees have highest burnout at 62.73	High
R5	Balanced performance and rewards system	FR-03: Productivity gap is small- motivation and engagement are likely bigger factors	Medium
R6	Monthly workload audits per team	FR-04: QA Engineers show 45% Poor mental health, highest of all roles	High
R7	Review Product Manager team size	FR-04: Product Managers have highest burnout (57.78) with smallest team of 9	Medium
R8	Commission India vs Australia investigation	FR-05: 28.18-point burnout gap between same-sized country groups	High
R9	Shift to proactive mental health strategy	FR-06: Therapist access is reactive; root causes must be addressed cautiously	High
R10	Standardized therapist access across all 7 countries	FR-06: Access to therapy is inconsistent globally	Medium

10. conclusion

This Gap Analysis confirms that the challenges of workforce wellbeing are multi-dimensional and cannot be addressed through one intervention such as access to therapist alone. The data shows that the key drivers of burnout across the organization are sleep quality, work mode structure and uneven distribution of workload. The hybrid work model is the most sustainable setup, as it offers the best balance of low burnout and high productivity. Remote work offers the best perception of work-life balance, but it causes structural burnout even in mentally healthy employees, pointing to boundary and routine problems that must be solved by policy, not by individual effort.

The most important regional finding is the India-Australia burnout gap of 28.18 points, which needs to be investigated urgently. Such large regional disparities indicate that specific cultural, infrastructural, or workload factors in these regions need to be understood before any targeted intervention can be designed. Etheria should immediately action the 5 High-priority recommendations, treating workforce wellbeing as a business performance strategy, not an HR function. A healthier, more balanced workforce will directly translate to greater product quality, reduced attrition and improved organizational resilience.

Document Sign-Off

By signing below, stakeholders confirm this Gap Analysis, and recommendations are approved for implementation planning.

Business Analyst: _____ **Date:** _____

HR Head, Etheria: _____ **Date:** _____

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